State of California

Department of Technology

Project Delegation Request

Preparation Instructions

Version 3.0

Statewide Information Management Manual – Section 19E

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INTRODUCTION TO
THE PROJECT DELEGATION REQUEST

Overview

The Project Approval Lifecycle (PAL) is divided into four stages, with approval required for each stage. Each stage consists of a set of prescribed, cross-functional, and parallel activities to develop deliverables used as the inputs for the next stage. The gates provide a series of "go/no go" decision points that request only the necessary and known information needed to make sound decisions for that particular point in time. The four stages, which document the business analysis, alternatives analysis, procurement analysis and solution analysis, must be approved by the California Department of Technology (CDT) prior to the encumbrance or expenditure of funds, including the use of staff resources, on any IT project beyond the PAL.

These instructions describe how an Agency/state entity may request an exemption from reporting the results of up to three stages of the PAL (Stage 2 Alternatives Analysis, Stage 3 Solution Development and/or Stage 4 Project Readiness and Approval) to the CDT. Each Agency/state entity's request for exemption will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis. Exempting an Agency/state entity from reporting to the CDT does not eliminate the requirement to prepare the Stage/Gate deliverables. The requirements for PAL Project Delegation Requests (PAL-PDRs), including the circumstances in which Stage/Gate deliverables must be approved by the CDT, are described in policy contained in State Administrative Manual (SAM) Sections 4819.37 and 4819.38.

A prerequisite to submitting a PAL-PDR is that the proposal must have an approved Stage 1 Business Analysis (S1BA) and the Agency/state entity must have an acceptable Technology Recovery Plan and an Agency Information Management Strategy approved by the CDT. Agencies/state entities must provide sufficient information in the PAL-PDR and any necessary supporting documentation for the CDT to evaluate the business and fiscal factors associated with the proposal. The documentation provided must enable the CDT to understand and concur with the relative need for, cost of, and benefits to be derived from the proposed IT investment. Specifically, the information must establish that the Agency/state entity has the capability and capacity to successfully approve, plan, and execute the project under its own authority.

Project Delegation Request Reporting Requirements

Projects that meet the following criteria are generally reportable to the CDT and require the approval of a PAL-PDR in order for approval authority to be delegated to the Agency/state entity:

- A budget action is required to fund all or part of the IT expenditure.
- The total development cost is above the Information Technology Project Cost Delegation (PCD) established by the CDT.
- The new system development or acquisition is specifically required by legislative mandate or is subject to specific legislative review, as specified in Budget Act control language or other legislation.
- Any conditions occur that require reporting to the CDT, as previously imposed by the CDT.

If delegated, the following individuals must approve the Stage/Gate deliverables in lieu of the CDT's approvals:

- Agency Secretary, if the state entity reports to an Agency Secretary